2014 Lok Sabha battle. ‘Why are Rahul Gandhi and Narendra Modi silent on gas prices?’ asked Kejriwal.

When the allegations were first made in 2012, the Ambanis were rattled. All the channels which telecast the press conference live received legal notices for defamation. Many channels blacked out the AAP, fearing the wrath of Reliance. At Network 18, a meeting was called and we decided to refrain from going ‘live’ with a press conference or speech where personal allegations were being made, without getting a proper response from the other side.

We had reason to be cautious. In January 2012, Reliance Industries had made a large investment in Network 18. To be fair, Reliance had not interfered in the editorial content of the channels. They were truly, as our promoter Raghav Bahl kept reassuring us, being kept at arm’s-length.

The build-up to campaign 2014 changed all that. In every public meeting, Kejriwal would single out the Ambanis as his prime target. Raghav asked me to look to my ‘conscience’ and exercise due diligence. ‘Why do we need to show everything Kejriwal does in such detail?’ he asked me. I promised to be careful in not giving disproportionate coverage, but made it clear that any boycott of Kejriwal in an election year was journalistically unsound.

In April, we did a Google+ Hangout with Kejriwal, one amongst several we had planned with top politicians. About an hour before the programme was to be recorded, we got a restraint notice from Reliance’s lawyers, warning us not to go ahead with the interview. Our in-house legal team was flustered by the notice. ‘Can we please drop the programme? Why do we need to pick a fight with Reliance?’ they asked. I refused. ‘Look, we are not taking a *panga* with anyone, just doing a professional job.’ We had been promoting the interview since the morning on the channel and withdrawing it at the last moment was just not an option. Google backed our stand. ‘Look, we are aware of the sensibilities involved here and will not allow anything to be aired that is potentially defamatory,’ I assured our legal team. A few minutes before the programme went on air, I got another mail from the Reliance lawyers, urging us to back off. We went ahead and aired the programme that night but ensured we edited out any personal attacks.